

008. Chapter 2 Verse 20-22

Lectures by Swami Sarvapriyananda

VERSE 2.20

न जायते म्रियते वा कदाचि
नायं भूत्वा भविता वा न भूयः ।
अजो नित्यः शाश्वतोऽयं पुराणो
न हन्यते हन्यमाने शरीरे ॥ 20 ॥

na jāyate mriyate vā kadācin-
nāyaṃ bhūtvā bhavitā vā na bhūyaḥ |
ajo nityaḥ śāśvato'yaṃ purāṇo
na hanyate hanyamāne śarīre ||

◆ **na** - never; **jāyate** - is born; **mriyate** - dies; **vā** - or; **kadācit** - at any time;

◆ **na** - not; **ayam** - this; **bhūtvā** - having been; **bhavitā** - will be; **vā** - or; **na** - not; **bhūyaḥ** - again;

◆ **ajah** - unborn; **nityaḥ** - eternal; **śāśvataḥ** - changeless; **ayam** - this; **purāṇaḥ** - ancient;

◆ **na** - not; **hanyate** - is killed; **hanyamāne** - being killed; **śarīre** - in the body.

Atma is not born, nor does it ever die; after having been it does not cease to be, unborn, eternal, changeless and ancient, it is not killed when the body is destroyed.

VERSE 2.21

DEVAGIAवेदाविनाशिनं नित्यं य एनमजमव्ययम् ।
कथं स पुरुषः पार्थ कं घातयति हन्ति कम् ॥ 21 ॥

vedāvināśinaṃ nityaṃ
ya enamajamavyayam |
kathaṃ sa puruṣaḥ pārtha
kaṃ ghātayati hanti kaṃ ||

- ◆ **veda** - knows; **avināśinaṃ** - indestructible; **nityaṃ** - eternal;
- ◆ **yaḥ** - who; **enam** - this; **ajam** - unborn; **avyayam** - immutable;
- ◆ **kathaṃ** - how; **saḥ** - that; **puruṣaḥ** - person; **pārtha** - O Partha (Arjuna);
- ◆ **kaṃ** - whom; **ghātayati** - causes to be killed; **hanti** - kills; **kaṃ** - whom.

O Arjuna! He who knows that Atma is birthless, deathless, real, and imperishable, whom can he slay or cause to be slain?

VERSE 2.22

वासांसि जीर्णानि यथा विहाय
नवानि गृह्णाति नरोऽपराणि ।
तथा शरीराणि विहाय जीर्णा
न्यन्यानि संयाति नवानि देही ॥ 22 ॥

vāsāṃsi jīrṇāni yathā vihāya
navāni grhṇāti naro'parāṇi |
tathā śarīrāṇi vihāya jīrṇāny
anyāni saṃyāti navāni dehī ||

- ◆ vāsāṃsi - clothes; jīrṇāni - worn out; yathā - as; vihāya - casting off;
- ◆ navāni - new; grhṇāti - takes on; narah - a man; aparāṇi - others;
- ◆ tathā - so; śarīrāṇi - bodies; vihāya - casting off; jīrṇāni - worn out;
- ◆ anyāni - others; saṃyāti - enters; navāni - new; dehī - the embodied Soul.

Just as a man casts off his worn-out clothes and puts on new ones so also the Self throws away its worn-out bodies and takes other fresh bodies.